

Wrongful Conviction Intake Guide

Initial triage framework for evaluating cases that may warrant innocence investigation.

NOTE: Initial intake only — not legal advice. All cases must be referred to qualified innocence attorneys. Contact IRNVP@pm.me for referrals.

Part 1 — Basic Intake

Incarcerated Person Name	
DOC Number / Location	
Contact Submitting Form	
Crime Convicted Of	
Year of Conviction	
Sentence Length	
Currently Appealing?	Yes / No — Stage: _____
Trial Type	☐ Jury ☐ Judge (bench trial)

Part 2 — Evidence Review

☐ Trial transcripts available	☐ Appellate records available
☐ Physical evidence preserved	☐ DNA evidence exists
☐ Witness statements on record	☐ Original police reports obtained
☐ Defense attorney files reviewed	☐ Lab/forensic reports reviewed
☐ Expert witnesses used at trial	☐ Alibi witnesses available

Part 3 — Legal Theories to Evaluate

Legal Theory	Definition	Applies?	Evidence
Brady Violation	Prosecution withheld favorable evidence		
Ineffective Assistance	Defense failed to meet basic standards		
New Evidence	Evidence unavailable at trial now available		

Legal Theory	Definition	Applies?	Evidence
False Confession	Confession was coerced or involuntary		
Eyewitness Misidentification	Witness ID was unreliable or coached		
Junk Science	Forensic methods since discredited		
Prosecutorial Misconduct	Prosecutors acted improperly		
Perjured Testimony	Key witness lied at trial		

Part 4 — Referral Pathways

Organization	Focus	Contact
Virginia Innocence Project	Post-conviction DNA & non-DNA cases	lawschool.richmond.edu/innocence
Mid-Atlantic Innocence Project	VA, MD, DC cases	innocenceproject.org
MacArthur Justice Center	Police/prison misconduct	macarthurjustice.org
Virginia Legal Aid Society	Criminal appeals	(800) 393-7910
IRN Legal Network	Case coordination & community support	IRNVP@pm.me

Part 5 — Case Coordinator Notes

Initial Assessment	☐ Refer to innocence org ☐ Needs more info ☐ Does not meet threshold
Priority	☐ High — time-sensitive appeal ☐ Medium ☐ Low
Assigned To	
Next Steps	
Date of Review	